

# ANCIENT HISTORY — PART 2

COMPLETED v2

HARAPPAN / INDUS VALLEY CIVILIZATION

Sites Town Planning Economy Script & Seals Decline PYQ Gap-Fill

Part 2 / 7 — Ancient History Series — SSC CGL / CHSL / CPO / MTS-GD

## CGL READY PROMISE

This is the completed Part 2 sheet. It keeps the full original lecture-based content and adds a verified **PYQ Gap-Fill Supplement** (Section 20) built from real SSC CGL/CHSL/CPO/MTS previous-year questions (1999–2024) so nothing from this topic catches you off guard. Where the lecture's simplified framing differs from an actual PYQ answer, both are shown with a clear trap flag.

## 1. Identity, Name & Discovery

| Question                         | CGL answer                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| What is Harappan Civilization?   | The first major urban civilization of the Indian subcontinent; commonly called the Indus Valley / Harappan Civilization.     |
| Why "Harappan"?                  | Harappa was the first major site excavated in the sequence used by the lecture, so the civilization is often named after it. |
| Harappa discovery (lecture)      | Dayaram Sahni — 1921                                                                                                         |
| Mohenjo-daro discovery (lecture) | R. D. Banerji — 1922                                                                                                         |
| Lothal discovery (lecture)       | S. R. Rao                                                                                                                    |
| Name attribution (lecture)       | John Marshall is stated as the person who named the civilization                                                             |
| Archaeological body              | Archaeological Survey of India (ASI)                                                                                         |

### GAP-FILL TRAP: EARLIEST EXCAVATOR (NEW)

The lecture credits Dayaram Sahni (1921) with discovering Harappa, which is correct for the **major/formal 1921 excavation**. But an important separate PYQ fact: **Sir Alexander Cunningham** — the "Father of Indian Archaeology" — had already begun preliminary excavations at Harappa as early as **1863-64 and 1872-73**, decades before Sahni's systematic 1921 dig. If a question asks who is called the "Father of Indian Archaeology" or references 1860s-70s Harappa digs, the answer is Cunningham, not Sahni.

## 2. Chronology & Phases

### MUST REMEMBER

Early Phase → Mature Phase → Late Phase. Mature Phase = **2600-1900 BC** (lecture's emphasized range).

| Phase           | Exam understanding        | Key point                                                     |
|-----------------|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Early Harappan  | Pre-urban/formative stage | Regional cultures before full urban maturity                  |
| Mature Harappan | 2600-1900 BC (lecture)    | Peak urbanization, standardized planning, long-distance trade |
| Late Harappan   | After c. 1900 BC          | Urban system declines; regionalisation                        |

### DATE-RANGE CAUTION (NEW)

Different sources give different overall spans for the full civilization: the lecture's Mature Phase is **2600-1900 BC**, but many competitive-exam sources (Cracku, Examveda etc.) give the **full civilization** span as **3300 BC - 1300 BC**, and some MCQs use **2500-1750 BC** for the mature/urban period. If a question specifies "mature phase," go with 2600-1900 BC; if it asks for the overall/full civilization span, 3300-1300 BC is the commonly tested answer.

## 3. Geographical Extent — Very Important

| Direction | Site         | Location                             | Memory            |
|-----------|--------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------|
| North     | Manda        | Jammu & Kashmir (on the Chenab)      | Northernmost site |
| South     | Daimabad     | Maharashtra (Godavari region)        | Southernmost site |
| East      | Alamgirpur   | Uttar Pradesh (Yamuna region)        | Easternmost site  |
| West      | Sutkagen Dor | Balochistan, Pakistan (Makran coast) | Westernmost site  |

### MEMORY

M-D-A-S = Manda North • Daimabad South • Alamgirpur East • Sutkagen Dor West.

### TRAP

If asked which Indian state is outside the Harappan distribution, the lecture uses **Uttarakhand** as an example.

#### 4. Master Site Table

| Site             | State/region          | River/location                                                           | CGL signature                                                                            |
|------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Harappa          | Punjab, Pakistan      | Ravi                                                                     | Discovery: Dayaram Sahni (1921); earlier prelim. digs by Cunningham (1860s-70s); Granary |
| Mohenjo-daro     | Sindh, Pakistan       | Indus                                                                    | Discovery: R. D. Banerji (1922); Great Bath                                              |
| Lothal           | Gujarat               | Bhogava/Bhogawa (a tributary of Sabarmati), near Gulf of Cambay/Khambhat | Dockyard/ancient port; bead industry; only site with artificial brick dockyard           |
| Kalibangan       | Rajasthan             | Ghaggar                                                                  | Fire altars + ploughed field; black bangles; mud bricks used extensively for houses      |
| Banawali         | Haryana               | Ghaggar system                                                           | Barley evidence                                                                          |
| Dholavira        | Gujarat               | Khadir Bet Island                                                        | Water reservoirs; large open area/terraced stands identified as a "stadium"              |
| Rakhigarhi       | Haryana               | Ghaggar-Hakra region                                                     | One of the largest Harappan urban centres                                                |
| Chanhudaro       | Sindh, Pakistan       | Indus region                                                             | Craft/bead production; city without a citadel                                            |
| Surkotada        | Gujarat               | Kutch region                                                             | Animal remains (horse bone); fortified settlement                                        |
| Alamgirpur       | Uttar Pradesh         | Yamuna region                                                            | Eastern extent                                                                           |
| Manda            | Jammu region          | Chenab region                                                            | Northern extent                                                                          |
| Sutkagen Dor     | Balochistan, Pakistan | Makran coast                                                             | Western extent; coastal trade context                                                    |
| Daimabad         | Maharashtra           | Godavari region                                                          | Southern extent                                                                          |
| Ropar (Rupnagar) | Punjab, India         | Sutlej                                                                   | NEW — Harappan site on the Sutlej; burial with dog found here                            |
| Mitathal         | Haryana               | —                                                                        | NEW — important site for evidence of the decline of Harappan culture                     |

#### 5. Town Planning — Core of Harappan Civilization

| Feature            | What to remember                                                                                      | CGL trigger                 |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Grid planning      | Roads organised, intersecting at planned angles; streets are described as wide and straight           | Urban planning              |
| Citadel            | Raised/fortified western part of the city; smaller and higher — also called "City-Citadel"            | Citadel = higher mound      |
| Lower Town         | Residential/working area below the citadel                                                            | Citadel + Lower Town        |
| Burnt/baked bricks | Standardised construction — houses built of "pucca"/burnt bricks (per SSC CGL 2001 PYQ)               | Standardisation             |
| Drainage           | Covered/organised drains; at Lothal (per Ernest Mackay, 1948) drains were made of <b>burnt bricks</b> | Advanced sanitation         |
| Wells & bathrooms  | Many houses had water facilities and bathing arrangements                                             | Urban hygiene               |
| Public buildings   | Granaries, halls, baths and other civic structures                                                    | Organised urban authority   |
| Fortification      | Walled settlements and gateways at several sites                                                      | Security/civic organisation |

**DIRECT PYQ TRAP (NEW)**  
"Which was **NOT** a common feature of major Harappan cities?" — Options usually include town planning, burnt bricks, irrigation canals, fortified citadel. The correct answer (i.e. the one that was **NOT** common) is **irrigation canals** (SSC MTS 25-10-2017, Shift 1). Do not assume irrigation canals were a defining feature.

#### 6. Citadel, Lower Town & Dholavira Exception

**MUST REMEMBER**  
Most Harappan urban sites are broadly divided into two parts, while Dholavira is highlighted as having **three** parts.

| General Harappan pattern | Dholavira pattern              |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Citadel/raised area      | Citadel                        |
| Lower Town               | Middle Town                    |
| (two-part general rule)  | Lower Town (three parts total) |

**WATER MEMORY**  
Dholavira → Khadir Bet → reservoirs → water management; also a large open terraced area interpreted as a "stadium."

**GAP-FILL: WHAT'S IN THE CITADEL (NEW)**

SSC CPO (10-11-2022, Shift 2) PYQ: "Which of the following was **NOT** part of a citadel in Harappan architecture?" — Answer: **Residential buildings for the public** (public housing belonged to the Lower Town, not the Citadel). The Citadel housed the Great Bath/large baths for elites, granary and fire-altar (Agni Vedika) type ritual structures.

## 7. Site-Specific Features — High-Yield

| Site         | Feature                                                      | Why asked                                                                                             |
|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mohenjo-daro | Great Bath                                                   | Most famous Harappan public bath; built in the citadel mound, 3rd millennium BCE                      |
| Harappa      | Granary                                                      | Storage/organised urban economy                                                                       |
| Lothal       | Dockyard/port                                                | Maritime trade; only site with an artificial brick dockyard                                           |
| Kalibangan   | Fire altars                                                  | Religious/ritual association                                                                          |
| Kalibangan   | Ploughed field                                               | Agriculture evidence                                                                                  |
| Kalibangan   | Black bangles; extensive mud-brick housing                   | Distinctive lecture fact                                                                              |
| Dholavira    | Reservoir system; "stadium"-like terraced open area          | Water management                                                                                      |
| Banawali     | Barley                                                       | Agricultural evidence                                                                                 |
| Lothal       | Bead/craft activity                                          | Craft specialisation                                                                                  |
| Chanhudaro   | Craft/industrial settlement; no citadel                      | Beads and manufacturing                                                                               |
| Mohenjo-daro | Seal with half-human, half-buffalo monster attacking a tiger | NEW — echoes Sumerian myth (Aruru's monster vs Gilgamesh); evidence of international/cultural contact |

## 8. Economy — Agriculture, Animals & Crafts

| Area             | Important facts                                                                                                              |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Agriculture      | Wheat and barley were staple crops; also rye, sesame, peas. Wooden ploughs used; plough marks at Kalibangan.                 |
| Rice             | Evidence of rice at Lothal and Rangpur.                                                                                      |
| Cotton           | Harappans were the <b>first in the world</b> to produce/use cotton — an important early textile association.                 |
| Animal husbandry | Cattle, sheep, goats, dogs domesticated; humped bull a recurring icon.                                                       |
| Metals           | Copper and bronze technology; gold and silver ornaments; stone tools still used; <b>Iron was NOT known</b> to the Harappans. |
| Crafts           | Beads, pottery, seals, terracotta figurines, shell, ivory, bone and faience objects.                                         |
| Specialisation   | Craft centres and specialised production indicate organised urban economy.                                                   |

**DIRECT PYQ FACTS (NEW)**  
"Harappans were the first to produce \_\_\_\_" → **Cotton** (a recurring direct PYQ). "Which domesticated animal was **absent** in the terracottas of the Indus civilisation?" → **Cat** (options usually: cat/dog/elephant/cow — cat is the one notably missing from terracotta figurine evidence). "Which metal was **not** found in Harappan civilization?" → **Iron**.

## 9. Trade & External Contacts

| Topic               | CGL-ready fact                                                                    |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Internal trade      | Exchange occurred among Harappan settlements and regions                          |
| External trade      | Links with Mesopotamia and Persian Gulf networks                                  |
| Mesopotamian name   | Harappan region often associated with <b>Meluhha</b> in Mesopotamian records      |
| Gulf intermediaries | Links through Oman and Bahrain in the Persian Gulf                                |
| Lothal              | Major maritime/port centre in Gujarat, with direct sea-trade links to Mesopotamia |
| Trade goods         | Beads, metals, pottery, shell products                                            |

**TRAP**  
Do not reduce Harappan trade to river trade only — Lothal + Gulf connections + Mesopotamia is the key maritime chain. "Which Harappan site is thought to have direct sea trade links with Mesopotamia?" → **Lothal**.

## 10. Seals, Script, Weights & Measurement

| Feature       | What to learn                                                                              |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Seals         | Steatite seals are the most characteristic Harappan artefact; used in administration/trade |
| Unicorn motif | Most frequently highlighted animal motif on Harappan seals                                 |

|                   |                                                                                                                                             |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Script            | Harappan script remains <b>undeciphered</b> ; inscriptions are generally short                                                              |
| Writing direction | Many inscriptions generally read right-to-left (Boustrophedon style)                                                                        |
| Weights           | Standardised weights; at <b>Lothal</b> , weights made of <b>limestone and steatite</b> , usually cubical in shape, in a 16/multiples system |
| Faience           | Artificially produced glazed material used in beads and decorative objects                                                                  |

**MUST REMEMBER**  
Harappan Script = Undeciphered. Tamil Nadu government has offered \$1 million to whoever decodes it.

## 11. Religion & Religious Evidence

| Association           | Exam-oriented note                                                                                                                                            |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mother Goddess        | Terracotta female figurines interpreted as a fertility/mother-goddess tradition; a tree growing from the womb symbolises Mother Earth                         |
| Pashupati/Proto-Shiva | Famous seal — horned figure in yogic posture surrounded by animals (bull, elephant, tiger, rhino — remember "BETTER DEER"); called Pashupati seal/Proto-Shiva |
| Tree worship          | Plant/tree motifs and ritual associations on seals                                                                                                            |
| Animal worship        | Bull and other creatures prominent in seals/iconography                                                                                                       |
| Fire altars           | Kalibangan and Lothal — the only two sites with fire altars                                                                                                   |
| Great Bath            | Mohenjo-daro; linked with ritual bathing                                                                                                                      |
| Temples               | No unmistakable temple structure comparable to later Indian temple architecture has been securely identified                                                  |

**TRAP**  
Use wording like "evidence suggests/often interpreted as" — the undeciphered script prevents certainty about beliefs.

## 12. Art & Iconic Objects

| Object/site          | CGL trigger                                                                                                    |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Dancing Girl         | Mohenjo-daro; bronze sculpture; Tribhanga posture (dance pose); height 10.5 cm; lost-wax/cire perdue technique |
| Priest-King          | Mohenjo-daro; steatite male bust; height 17.5 cm; identity uncertain                                           |
| Terracotta figurines | Common Harappan artefacts; female figurines linked to fertility                                                |
| Seals                | Steatite; animal motifs; unicorn especially famous                                                             |
| Pottery              | Red ware with black painted designs is the common Harappan ceramic association                                 |
| Beads                | Carnelian and other stones; specialised bead-making a major craft                                              |

**DIRECT PYQ (NEW)**  
"Which country has asked India to return the famous 'Dancing Girl' statue found at Mohenjodaro?" → **Pakistan** (a recurring current-affairs-linked history PYQ).

**MEMORY**  
Dancing Girl → Bronze → Mohenjo-daro | Great Bath → Mohenjo-daro | Priest-King → Mohenjo-daro | Dockyard → Lothal | Fire Altars + Ploughed Field → Kalibangan.

## 13. Society, Clothing & Burials

| Topic            | CGL-ready notes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Urban society    | Large cities, craft specialists, traders, farmers, labourers, administrators — occupational differentiation. Widely described as a <b>fairly egalitarian</b> social system in exam material (no strong evidence of caste/slave-based hierarchy). |
| Racial types     | NEW — skeletal evidence suggests four racial types: Proto-Australoid, Mediterranean, Alpinoid and Mongoloid; the Mediterranean type is considered most common.                                                                                   |
| Ornaments        | Gold, silver, shell, faience, semi-precious stones used for jewellery                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Clothing         | Cotton was known; wool also used                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Burials          | Extended burials are common; double/joint burials at Lothal; coffin burial at Harappa                                                                                                                                                            |
| Social structure | Large public works imply organised authority, but no single clear king/emperor model is established                                                                                                                                              |

**EXAM SAFETY**  
Learn artefact/site associations rather than speculative claims about who ruled Harappan cities. Avoid treating "matriarchal society" as a proven fact.

## 14. Decline of Harappan Civilization

**MUST REMEMBER**  
Decline = gradual transformation/regionalisation after c. 1900 BC, not a single proven disaster.

| Proposed factor     | How to remember                                                                                                                                                                |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Climate/aridity     | Increasing dryness affecting agriculture/settlement                                                                                                                            |
| River changes       | Changes in river courses/hydrology disrupting settlements                                                                                                                      |
| Flooding            | Repeated floods discussed especially for Mohenjo-daro                                                                                                                          |
| Trade disruption    | Long-distance trade networks may have weakened                                                                                                                                 |
| Ecological stress   | Environmental pressure contributing to regional decline                                                                                                                        |
| Old invasion theory | <b>Mortimer Wheeler</b> is the historian traditionally associated with attributing the decline to Aryan invasion — this theory is now not accepted as a sufficient explanation |
| Post-decline site   | Mitathal (Haryana) shows evidence for the decline phase of Harappan culture                                                                                                    |

**DIRECT PYQ (NEW)**  
"Which historian is of the opinion that the decline of Indus Valley Civilization is due to Aryan invasion?" → **Mortimer Wheeler**.

## 15. Ultimate Site → Feature → River/State Table

| Site         | State/region     | River/setting        | One-word trigger             |
|--------------|------------------|----------------------|------------------------------|
| Harappa      | Punjab, Pakistan | Ravi                 | Sahni / Granary              |
| Mohenjo-daro | Sindh, Pakistan  | Indus                | Great Bath / Dancing Girl    |
| Lothal       | Gujarat          | Bhogava              | Dockyard / Port              |
| Kalibangan   | Rajasthan        | Ghaggar              | Fire altars / Ploughed field |
| Banawali     | Haryana          | Ghaggar system       | Barley                       |
| Dholavira    | Gujarat          | Khadir Bet           | Reservoirs / "Stadium"       |
| Rakhigarhi   | Haryana          | Ghaggar-Hakra region | Major urban centre           |
| Chanhudaro   | Sindh, Pakistan  | Indus region         | Crafts/beads; no citadel     |
| Surkotada    | Gujarat          | Kutch                | Fortification/horse remains  |
| Manda        | Jammu region     | Chenab region        | Northern extent              |
| Alamgirpur   | Uttar Pradesh    | Yamuna region        | Eastern extent               |
| Sutkagen Dor | Balochistan      | Makran coast         | Western extent               |
| Daimabad     | Maharashtra      | Godavari region      | Southern extent              |
| Ropar        | Punjab, India    | Sutlej               | Dog burial                   |
| Mitathal     | Haryana          | —                    | Decline-phase evidence       |

## 16. CGL Master Revision — 35+ Direct Facts

| Trigger                                           | Answer                                                     |
|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| Harappan Civilization                             | First major urban civilization of the Indian subcontinent  |
| Harappa discovery (formal, 1921)                  | Dayaram Sahni                                              |
| Earlier preliminary Harappa digs (1860s-70s)      | Alexander Cunningham — "Father of Indian Archaeology"      |
| Mohenjo-daro discovery                            | R. D. Banerji — 1922                                       |
| Lothal discovery                                  | S. R. Rao                                                  |
| Mature Harappan phase                             | 2600–1900 BC                                               |
| Full civilization span (commonly tested)          | 3300 BC – 1300 BC                                          |
| Northernmost                                      | Manda                                                      |
| Southernmost                                      | Daimabad                                                   |
| Easternmost                                       | Alamgirpur                                                 |
| Westernmost                                       | Sutkagen Dor                                               |
| Harappa river                                     | Ravi                                                       |
| Mohenjo-daro river                                | Indus                                                      |
| Lothal river                                      | Bhogava/Bhogawa (tributary of Sabarmati)                   |
| Kalibangan river system                           | Ghaggar                                                    |
| Ropar river                                       | Sutlej                                                     |
| Banawali state                                    | Haryana                                                    |
| Dholavira island                                  | Khadir Bet                                                 |
| Great Bath                                        | Mohenjo-daro                                               |
| Granary                                           | Harappa                                                    |
| Dockyard                                          | Lothal                                                     |
| Fire altars                                       | Kalibangan (and Lothal)                                    |
| Ploughed field                                    | Kalibangan                                                 |
| Black bangles                                     | Kalibangan                                                 |
| Reservoir system / "stadium"                      | Dholavira                                                  |
| Barley evidence                                   | Banawali                                                   |
| Script                                            | Undeciphered                                               |
| Famous seal motif                                 | Unicorn                                                    |
| Pashupati seal                                    | Horned figure surrounded by animals                        |
| Dancing Girl                                      | Bronze; Mohenjo-daro; Tribhanga posture                    |
| Priest-King                                       | Steatite; Mohenjo-daro                                     |
| Houses built of                                   | Burnt/pucca bricks                                         |
| Feature NOT common to Harappan cities             | Irrigation canals                                          |
| NOT part of the citadel                           | Residential buildings for the public                       |
| Standardised bricks                               | Harappan urban construction                                |
| Drainage material at Lothal (Ernest Mackay, 1948) | Burnt bricks                                               |
| External trade                                    | Mesopotamia/Persian Gulf                                   |
| Gulf links                                        | Oman + Bahrain                                             |
| Harappans first to produce                        | Cotton                                                     |
| Animal absent in terracotta                       | Cat                                                        |
| Metal not found in Harappan civilization          | Iron                                                       |
| Weights material (Lothal)                         | Limestone/steatite, cubical                                |
| Social system                                     | Fairly egalitarian                                         |
| Racial type most common                           | Mediterranean (also Proto-Australoid, Alpinoid, Mongoloid) |
| Decline attributed to Aryan invasion by           | Mortimer Wheeler (theory now not fully accepted)           |
| Country demanding return of Dancing Girl          | Pakistan                                                   |
|                                                   |                                                            |

|                               |                                         |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Decline                       | Gradual transformation after c. 1900 BC |
| Site showing decline evidence | Mitathal, Haryana                       |

### 17. PYQ-Style Question Bank (Original Set)

- Q1.** Why is it commonly called Harappa? **Ans:** Harappa was first discovered/excavated.
- Q2.** Who discovered Harappa in 1921? **Ans:** Dayaram Sahni.
- Q3.** Who discovered Mohenjo-daro in 1922? **Ans:** R. D. Banerji.
- Q4.** Mature phase of Harappan civilization? **Ans:** 2600–1900 BC.
- Q5.** Northernmost Harappan site? **Ans:** Manda.
- Q6.** Southernmost? **Ans:** Daimabad.
- Q7.** Easternmost? **Ans:** Alamgirpur.
- Q8.** Westernmost? **Ans:** Sutkagen Dor.
- Q9.** Harappa lies on which river? **Ans:** Ravi.
- Q10.** Mohenjo-daro lies on which river? **Ans:** Indus.
- Q11.** Lothal is famous for? **Ans:** Dockyard/ancient port.
- Q12.** Kalibangan's two major features? **Ans:** Ploughed field and fire altars.
- Q13.** Dholavira's water feature? **Ans:** Reservoir/water-management system.
- Q14.** Dholavira is on which island? **Ans:** Khadir Bet.
- Q15.** Banawali is in which state? **Ans:** Haryana.
- Q16.** Which site has the Great Bath? **Ans:** Mohenjo-daro.
- Q17.** Which site is associated with a granary? **Ans:** Harappa.
- Q18.** Status of the Harappan script? **Ans:** Undeciphered.
- Q19.** Famous animal motif on seals? **Ans:** Unicorn.
- Q20.** Dancing Girl is made of? **Ans:** Bronze.
- Q21.** Dancing Girl was found at? **Ans:** Mohenjo-daro.
- Q22.** What is the Pashupati seal? **Ans:** Horned figure surrounded by animals — Pashupati/Proto-Shiva.
- Q23.** Major external trade connection? **Ans:** Mesopotamia.
- Q24.** Persian Gulf regions in Harappan trade links? **Ans:** Oman and Bahrain.
- Q25.** Crop evidenced by ploughed fields at Kalibangan? **Ans:** Agricultural practice generally; site is the key association.
- Q26.** What happened after c. 1900 BC? **Ans:** Gradual decline/regionalisation.
- Q27.** Is Aryan invasion a sufficient modern explanation for decline? **Ans:** No — multiple environmental/economic factors.

**WHY THIS SECTION EXISTS**

Real SSC CGL/CHSL/MTS/CPO papers (1999–2024) ask several Harappan facts not covered by the lecture transcript alone — Cunningham's role, dates/date-ranges, house material, racial types, weights, the historian who blamed Aryan invasion, and specific "which is NOT a feature" trap questions. This section closes those gaps.

| PYQ-style trigger                                                              | Answer                                                                                     | Exam source                            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| "Father of Indian Archaeology" who began early Harappa digs (1860s-70s)        | Sir Alexander Cunningham                                                                   | SSC GD/MTS pattern                     |
| Full/overall civilization date span (as opposed to mature phase)               | 3300 BC – 1300 BC                                                                          | Cracku / Examveda SSC CGL sets         |
| Houses of the Indus Valley Civilization were made of                           | Brick (burnt/pucca bricks)                                                                 | SSC CGL 2001                           |
| NOT a common feature of major Harappan cities                                  | Irrigation canals                                                                          | SSC MTS 25-10-2017 Shift 1             |
| Streets of Harappan cities were                                                | Wide and straight                                                                          | SSC FCI 2012                           |
| Western part of Harappan cities (smaller, higher) called                       | City-Citadel                                                                               | SSC CGL 6-12-2022 Shift 1              |
| NOT part of a citadel in Harappan architecture                                 | Residential buildings for the public                                                       | SSC CPO 10-11-2022 Shift 2             |
| Harappan site "Ropar" is on which river                                        | Sutlej                                                                                     | PracticeMock SSC set                   |
| Harappan site "Manda" is on which river                                        | Chenab                                                                                     | PracticeMock SSC set                   |
| Domesticated animal absent in Indus terracottas                                | Cat                                                                                        | PracticeMock SSC set                   |
| First metal used by man                                                        | Copper                                                                                     | PracticeMock SSC set                   |
| Weights at Lothal were made of                                                 | Limestone, steatite (cubical shape)                                                        | Testbook MCQ bank                      |
| Dholavira's terraced open-area feature is identified as                        | A "stadium"                                                                                | Ancient Indian History SSC CGL PDF set |
| Historian linking IVC decline to Aryan invasion                                | Mortimer Wheeler                                                                           | Cracku SSC CGL set                     |
| IVC is described as a ___ age civilization                                     | Bronze Age                                                                                 | Cracku SSC CGL set                     |
| Racial types found in IVC skeletal remains                                     | Proto-Australoid, Mediterranean, Alpinoid, Mongoloid (Mediterranean most common)           | Careericons MCQ set                    |
| Iron was known to IVC people?                                                  | No — not known; first Indian iron evidence is later, at Atranjikhra (Etah, UP), c. 1000 BC | Careericons MCQ set                    |
| Site in 1948 where Ernest Mackay noted drains made of burnt bricks             | Lothal                                                                                     | SSC CGL 27/07/2023 2nd Shift pattern   |
| Lothal's exact river/location detail                                           | Near Gulf of Cambay/Khambhat, on river Bhogavo, a tributary of the Sabarmati               | Pinnacle SSC CGL notes                 |
| Country that has asked India to return the Dancing Girl statue                 | Pakistan                                                                                   | Ancient Indian History SSC CGL PDF set |
| Site with evidence of a plowing/ploughed area                                  | Kalibangan                                                                                 | Ancient Indian History SSC CGL PDF set |
| Which Harappan site used mud bricks in ample amount for house construction     | Kalibangan                                                                                 | Ancient Indian History SSC CGL PDF set |
| Only Indus site with an artificial brick dockyard (port town)                  | Lothal                                                                                     | Ancient Indian History SSC CGL PDF set |
| Harappan site thought to have direct sea trade links with Mesopotamia          | Lothal                                                                                     | Ancient Indian History SSC CGL PDF set |
| Dholavira is located in which state                                            | Gujarat                                                                                    | Ancient Indian History SSC CGL PDF set |
| Social system of the Harappans (nature)                                        | Fairly egalitarian                                                                         | Examveda MCQ set                       |
| Mohenjo-daro seal referencing a Sumerian myth                                  | Half-human/half-buffalo monster attacking a tiger (linked to Aruru vs Gilgamesh myth)      | Examveda MCQ set                       |
| Site showing evidence of the decline of Harappan culture (district-level fact) | Mitathal, Haryana                                                                          | Testbook CDS-pattern set               |

**Additional PYQ Q&A (Gap-Fill)**

**Q28.** Who is called the "Father of Indian Archaeology" and began the earliest Harappa excavations? **Ans:** Sir Alexander Cunningham (1863-64, 1872-73).

**Q29.** What is the full/overall date range commonly given for the Indus Valley Civilization? **Ans:** 3300 BC – 1300 BC.

- Q30.** What were Indus Valley houses usually built of? **Ans:** Brick (burnt/pucca bricks).
- Q31.** Which was NOT a common feature of major IVC cities? **Ans:** Irrigation canals.
- Q32.** How were the streets of Harappan cities typically described? **Ans:** Wide and straight.
- Q33.** What was the smaller, higher, western part of a Harappan city called? **Ans:** City-Citadel.
- Q34.** Which was NOT part of a Harappan citadel? **Ans:** Residential buildings for the public.
- Q35.** Which river is the Harappan site Ropar situated on? **Ans:** Sutlej.
- Q36.** Which river is the Harappan site Manda situated on? **Ans:** Chenab.
- Q37.** Which domesticated animal is absent in Indus terracotta figurines? **Ans:** Cat.
- Q38.** What was the first metal used by man? **Ans:** Copper.
- Q39.** What material were the weights at Lothal made of? **Ans:** Limestone and steatite (cubical shape).
- Q40.** What large structure at Dholavira is identified as a "stadium"? **Ans:** A large open area with terraced stands.
- Q41.** Which historian attributed the IVC's decline to Aryan invasion? **Ans:** Mortimer Wheeler.
- Q42.** IVC is described as which "age" civilization? **Ans:** Bronze Age.
- Q43.** What racial types are identified from IVC skeletal remains? **Ans:** Proto-Australoid, Mediterranean, Alpinoid, Mongoloid.
- Q44.** Was iron known to the Harappans? **Ans:** No.
- Q45.** According to Ernest Mackay (1948), what were Lothal's drainage-system bricks made of? **Ans:** Burnt bricks.
- Q46.** Which country has asked India to return the Dancing Girl statue? **Ans:** Pakistan.
- Q47.** Which site shows evidence of a plowed/ploughed area? **Ans:** Kalibangan.
- Q48.** Which site used mud bricks extensively for house construction? **Ans:** Kalibangan.
- Q49.** Which was the only Indus site with an artificial brick dockyard? **Ans:** Lothal.
- Q50.** Which Harappan site is thought to have direct sea trade links with Mesopotamia? **Ans:** Lothal.
- Q51.** Dholavira is located in which Indian state? **Ans:** Gujarat.
- Q52.** How is the Harappan social system generally described? **Ans:** Fairly egalitarian.

## 19. 30-Second Revision (Updated)

### THE CHAIN

DISCOVERY → Cunningham (1860s-70s prelim.) → Harappa formally 1921 (Sahni) → MATURITY 2600-1900 BC (full span 3300-1300 BC) → EXTENT Manda-Daimabad-Alamgirpur-Sutkagen Dor → TOWN PLANNING citadel/lower town + grid + burnt bricks + drainage (NOT irrigation canals) → SITES Great Bath/Granary/Dockyard/Fire Altars/Reservoirs/"Stadium" → ECONOMY agriculture + cotton (first) + crafts + trade (no iron) → CULTURE seals + undeciphered script + religion + art (Dancing Girl, Priest-King) → SOCIETY egalitarian, 4 racial types → DECLINE gradual after 1900 BC (Wheeler's Aryan-invasion theory now rejected).